

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/8: 1. Four axes of diversity

RELIGIOUS DIVERSITY OCCURS ALONG FOUR AXES

truth: contradictory doctrinal claims

salvation: who can attain liberation/salvation?

epistemic status: are others reasonable/justified?

civic status: what freedom and equality are owed?

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PLURALISM can answer one axis without answering all

tolerance is a political/moral practice; it is not yet a metaphysical claim
that all religions are equally true.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/8: 2. Exclusivism-inclusivism-pluralism

EXCLUSIVISM: one tradition alone has saving truth

INCLUSIVISM: one norm is final, but grace/truth operates beyond explicit membership

PLURALISM: multiple traditions are valid responses/routes to ultimate reality

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strengths: exclusivism preserves determinate truth; inclusivism widens salvation;

pluralism explains diversity and supports humility

costs: exclusion | patronising absorption | flattening real contradictions

each model must state truth criterion, salvation criterion and view of disagreement.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/8: 3. John Hick

THE REAL AN SICH (noumenal, beyond full conceptual capture)

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culturally shaped human responses

+> personal representations: God, Allah, Īśvara

+> non-personal representations: Brahman, nirvāṇa, emptiness

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religions assessed by transformation from self-centredness to Reality-centredness

KANTIAN distinction explains diversity without declaring all propositions identical

objections: Hick imposes a meta-theory; the Real becomes unknowable; transformation test is vague.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/8: 4. Vedāntic models

ADVAITA: one Brahman; differences belong to empirical standpoint;

many paths may prepare for non-dual knowledge

RĀMĀNUJA: real plurality within Brahman's unity; devotion to personal God remains final

RĀMAKṚṢṆA/VIVEKĀNANDA: diverse religious paths can realise one ultimate

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ABSOLUTE-TRUTH PROBLEM

if all views are partial, is “all are partial” itself absolute?

reply requires standpoint discipline, not effortless equivalence of incompatible claims.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/8: 5. Jain many-sidedness

ANEKĀNTAVĀDA: reality has many aspects

NAYAVĀDA: each finite statement arises from a standpoint

SYĀDVĀDA: predicate conditionally – in a certain respect

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pluralist use: rival religions may disclose different aspects without exhaustive possession

strength: epistemic humility + non-violence in judgement

limit: contradictions are reconciled only if respects genuinely differ;

syādvāda cannot simply pronounce every doctrine true in the same sense.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/8: 6. Tolerance and religious freedom

TOLERANCE: refrain from coercion despite disagreement

respect: recognise equal standing | dialogue: reciprocal reason-giving

freedom: belief, practice, change of religion, non-belief, association

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LIMITS

coercion | violence | discrimination | harm to rights may be regulated

but offence or theological falsity alone is not sufficient ground for suppression

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principled pluralism protects persons and conscience, not every practice from criticism.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/8: 7. Conflict, unification and deep disagreement

CONFLICT SOURCES: exclusive revelation | sacred history | identity | power | grievance
responses: syncretism | common ethical core | comparative theology | dialogue | legal neutrality
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DEEP DISAGREEMENT persists because standards of evidence are tradition-shaped
humility != relativism: give reasons, admit fallibility, seek overlap, preserve dissent
objections to pluralism: self-refuting, imperial meta-theory, doctrinal dilution
reply: modest pluralism can defend equal civic respect without equalising every truth claim.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/8: 8. PYQ answer spine

DEFINE axis -> map exclusivism/inclusivism/pluralism -> explain Hick exactly

-> compare Advaita/Rāmānuja/Jain anekānta -> test absolute-truth objection

-> move from metaphysical diversity to tolerance/freedom with limits

-> qualified conclusion

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CLOSE: defensible pluralism is neither “all religions say the same” nor relativism;

it combines truth-seeking, fallibilism, transformative comparison and equal civic liberty.